MARUTI SUZUKI

XCELerate 2026

Powering the Future of Mobility!









Platform Partner unstop

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THESIS.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

DESIGN THE IDEAL RIDE-SERVICE VEHICLE FOR INDIA 2035. DETERMINE THE OPTIMAL VEHICLE SIZE, SEATING CONFIGURATION, BODY STYLE, POWERTRAIN STRATEGY AND DIGITAL ECOSYSTEM FOR INTRA-CITY, INTER-CITY, SHARED AND PREMIUM MOBILITY SERVICES. THE SOLUTION SHOULD MAXIMIZE CUSTOMER SATISFACTION, DRIVER EARNINGS, FLEET PROFITABILITY AND SCALABILITY ACROSS INDIA.



THE FINDING

Volume is in intra-city. Margin is in airport and commute. They are structurally incompatible — 95 km/day unpredictable hail cannot share a vehicle design with 210 km/day pre-booked depot returns. We did not design for both. We designed for the margin segment.



THE BUYER

Fleet operators. Every commercial conversation ends at an operations manager's desk and that person buys on cost per km and utilisation. Under ₹67/day flat fee, revenue is fixed — only paid kilometres move the number. That makes uptime and depot control more important than range or features.



THE DESIGN

Sedan: airport fare premium + luggage requires separate boot. B-segment: sub-4-metre keeps GST at 5%, saves ₹1.5L. BEV on LFP: at 200 km/day return-to-base, depot overnight charging cuts energy cost below every alternative. 45 kWh: sized for the duty cycle with 10% reserve at year 8.

MACH1

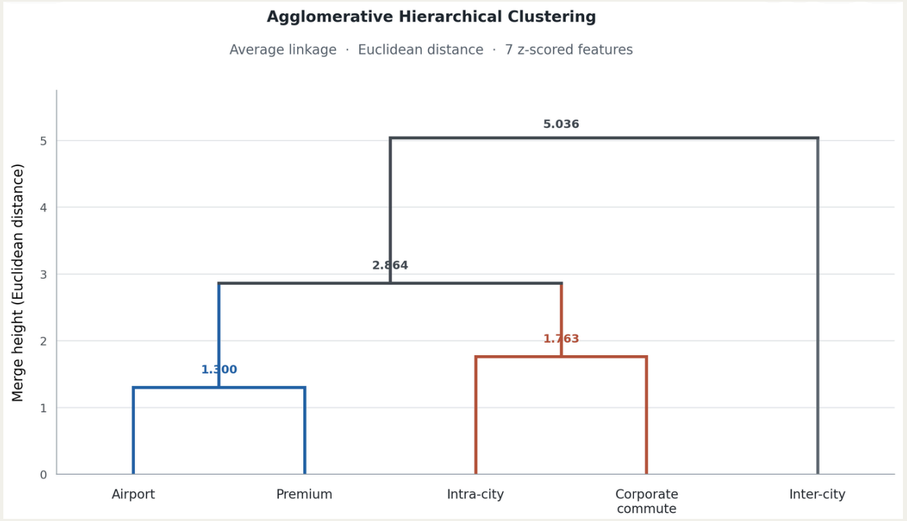
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MARKET

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WHAT DOES THE MARKET SAY?

USE CASE	AVG KM	KM/ DAY	TRIPS/ DAY	₹/TRIP	GROWTH	EV SHARE	PRICE SENS.
Intra-city street hail	12.7	95	7.5	350	18%	10%	0.85
Daily commute / subscription	22.0	176	8.0	550	24%	12%	0.90
Airport transfer	35.0	210	6.0	600	26%	18%	0.35
Inter-city / outstation	280	340	1.5	4,200	20%	5%	0.40
Premium / shared-premium	18.0	144	8.0	520	28%	15%	0.30



WHO IS OUR AUDIENCE?

FLEET OPERATORS.

Every commercial conversation about a fleet vehicle ends at an operations manager's desk, and that person buys on cost per kilometre and utilisation.. Structurally, drivers now choose the platform; operators choose the vehicle.

REPLACEMENT CAPACITY TARGETED AIRPORT AND CORPORATE TRAVEL:

1. EVERA EXPANDED AT DELHI TERMINALS
2. GMR HYDERABAD LAUNCHED A 200+ VEHICLE PREMIUM AIRPORT FLEET
3. BHARAT TAXI LAUNCHED AT NAVI MUMBAI.

BluSmart's exit redistributed supply toward high-utilisation,depot-controlled routes.

RANK	CRITERION	EVIDENCE
1	Cost per kilometre	every fleet TCO source converges here
2	Paid km/day (utilisation)	now the binding constraint under flat-fee platform economics
3	Uptime	charging downtime is the failure mode operators actually fear
4	Depot control	without controlled overnight charging, EV TCO does not hold
5	Residual value	BluSmart assumed 10%, realised 26% — our exact target segment
6	Financeability	CAPEX structure alone is worth ~8 points of EV advantage
7	Range	near the bottom — 315 km against a 200 km/day duty is ample

WHERE DO WE PITCH?

*India's ride-service **volume** is in intra-city.*
*India's ride-service **margin** is in airport and commute.*
*This matters because they require fundamentally **different** vehicles*

USE CASE	KM/DAY	GROWTH	EV SHARE	DRIVER ₹/MO	MACH1 FIT
intra-city	95	18%	10%	68,250	weak
premium	144	28%	15%	108,160	moderate
commute	176	24%	12%	114,400	STRONG
airport	210	26%	18%	93,600	STRONG
intercity	340	20%	5%	163,800	weak

THE PRIMARY POSITION
CLUSTER A — AIRPORT + CORPORATE-COMMUTE

- *TRIPS ARE PRE-BOOKED → THE VEHICLE'S DAY CAN BE PLANNED*
- *PICKUP IS A FIXED POINT → DEPOT CHARGING IS SCHEDULABLE OVERNIGHT*
- *THE DUTY IS PREDICTABLE → THE 45 KWH PACK AND THE 200 KM/DAY SIZING ARE SAFE*
- *EV SHARE IS ALREADY 18% → THE OPERATOR IS ALREADY ELECTRIFYING THIS LANE*

AIRPORT TRANSFERS ARE ALSO THE FASTEST-GROWING TRIP PURPOSE AT 19.14% CAGR, AND UBER BLACK'S TOP TWO USE CASES ARE AIRPORT AND CORPORATE TRAVEL.

WHERE WE DO NOT FIT

INTRA-CITY

- 61% OF THE MARKET, BUT WEAKEST FIT FOR E1.
- 95 KM/DAY; UNPREDICTABLE HAIL COMPLICATES DEPOT SCHEDULING.
- HIGHEST PRICE SENSITIVITY.

INTER-CITY

- 560 KM DRIVEN PER ROUND TRIP FOR 280 KM OF REVENUE.
- LOWEST EV SHARE: 5%.
- EMPTY RETURN TRIPS REDUCE EFFECTIVE UTILISATION AND WEAKEN ECONOMICS.

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VEHICLE CONCEPT PROPOSAL

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Powertrain & Energy

FLEETLINE E1 FEATURE	WHY A FLEET OPERATOR NEEDS IT
SPEC 45 kWh LFP pack, semi-structural CTP	200 km/day duty with 10% reserve held at year 8
SPEC PMSM 80 bhp, single-speed reduction drive	No shift loss across 62,400 km/yr, and no gearset to maintain
SPEC Liquid-plate cooling, 48 °C cell design point	Holds degradation inside the validated band — passive cooling does not
ADD ⚑ Per-cell pack SoH telematics, over-the-air	DECISIVE — THE ONE THAT EARNS THE WARRANTY. Published LFP studies disagree 3.6× on time-to-80%, so a capacity-retention guarantee is only credible if the pack reports its own degradation

Safety & Liability

FLEETLINE E1 FEATURE	WHY A FLEET OPERATOR NEEDS IT
SPEC L2 ADAS, six airbags, ABS with EBD + CSC	Corner Stability Control matters more on a tall, pack-loaded sedan
ADD 360° HD camera with 2D/3D views	Blind-spot elimination at low speed, and dense-city parking without a spotter
ADD Dashcam recorder (DVR)	10+ paid hours a day — onboard evidence for disputes, when the driver's account is not enough

Uptime & Reliability

FLEETLINE E1 FEATURE	WHY A FLEET OPERATOR NEEDS IT
ADD Intelligent tyre pressure monitoring	Turns a roadside blowout into a scheduled wheel change. Tyre failure is a leading cause of lost paid hours

Driver Working Conditions

FLEETLINE E1 FEATURE	WHY A FLEET OPERATOR NEEDS IT
ADD 65 W USB-C front + rear wireless phone deck	Two riders, two phones, one shift, no cable hunt between fares
ADD Ventilated front seats	A 12-hour shift is the working condition, not a luxury — heat and fatigue show up as unpaid kilometres

LEGEND

SPEC	Already specified — engineering locked
ADD	Being added — requested by this proposal
⚑ / DECISIVE	The line that converts a spec sheet into a commercial argument

Parameter	FleetLine E1
Body Style	Compact Sedan
Segment	B-segment
Length	3,995 mm
Width	1,684 mm
Height	1,532 mm
Wheelbase	2,450 mm
Seating	5-seat, 2-row
Boot Space	400 L ↑ Tour S
Powertrain	45 kWh BEV
Fleet Pricing	~₹14 L (EV)

THE DZIRE TOUR S IS INDIA'S GOLD-STANDARD FLEET SEDAN *5,000 UNITS/MONTH, 40% OF ALL DZIRE SALES, OPERATORS RETURN TO IT EVERY TIME. FLEETLINE E1 DOES NOT REINVENT THIS FORMULA. IT ELECTRIFIES IT.*

🏆 ***PROVEN IN INDIAN FLEET — MARKET EVIDENCE***

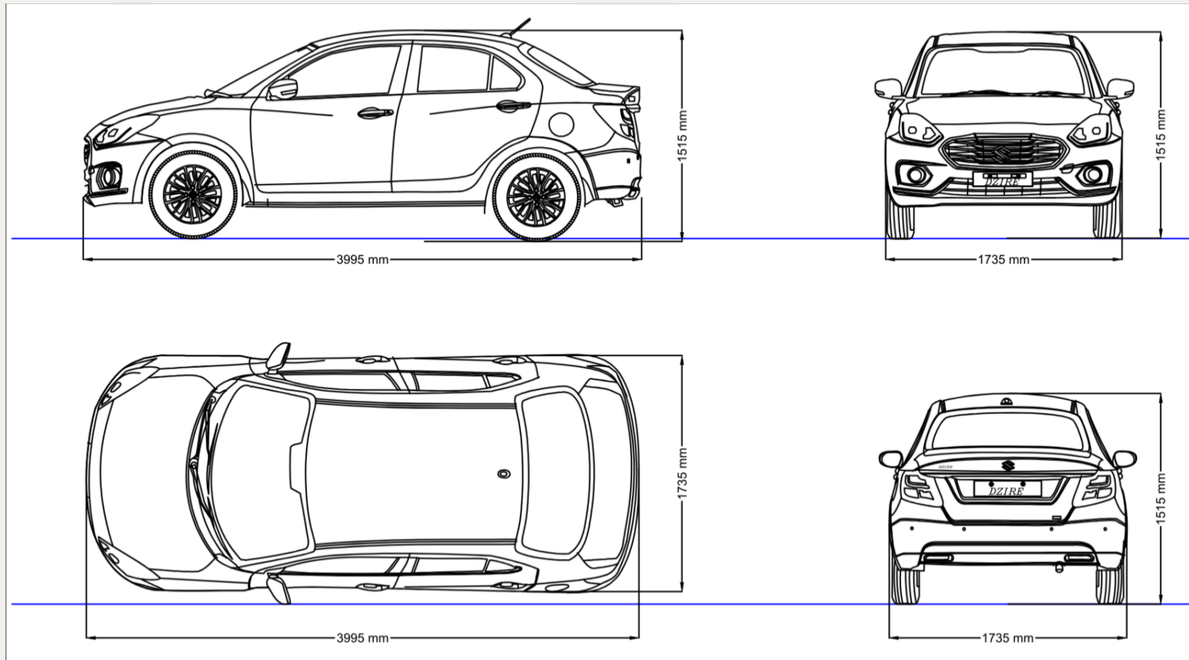
- *RETURNED TO TOP OF SALES CHARTS THE MOMENT MARUTI REOPENED FLEET REGISTRATIONS — OPERATORS RESPONDED IMMEDIATELY*
- *40% OF ALL DZIRE UNITS GO TO FLEET BUYERS — 5,000 UNITS/MONTH AT STEADY STATE*

📐 ***WHY THESE EXACT DIMENSIONS WORK***

- *2,450 MM WHEELBASE SEATS ADULTS WITHOUT DRAMA AND FITS EVERY AIRPORT BAY AND CITY LANE*

🔧 ***WHY OPERATORS CHOOSE IT OVER RIVALS***

- *MARUTI'S 3,614-OUTLET SERVICE NETWORK MEANS A CAB IS NEVER MORE THAN A FEW KM FROM A SERVICE POINT*
- *SPARE PARTS STOCKED EVERYWHERE — NO WAITING, NO IMPORTED COMPONENTS, NO DOWNTIME*



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TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS

POWERTRAIN	80 bhp continuous / 100 bhp peak - PMSM - Water-cooled *Peak + short duration, continuous rating derates at 45°C ambient*
DRIVE	Single-speed reduction - BEV
MOTOR EFFICIENCY	93–97% peak - –2% drop at 45°C
BATTERY / RANGE	LFP - 45 kWh - Structural pack 10–90% - 36 kWh usable *3% top and bottom reserved for cycle-life protection*
RANGE	263 km claimed - 200 km @ 75% DoD (feet (operating range)
DAILY ENERGY	–25.7 kWh @ 200 km/day - –20–35% with AC load at 45°C
PACK THERMAL MGMT	Active liquid cooling - pack maintained 45°-50°C ambient
CHARGE RATE	1C max - 45 kW DC fast charge - CC–CV protocol
DEPOT CHARGING	11 kW AC - 3-phase - 23 hr overnight window
RATED LIFE	200,000+ km - –3.2 yr at 62,400 km/yr duty cycle
BRAKING / CHASSIS	Front: Disc - Rear : Drum ABS - ESC
WHEELS / TIRES	14' alloy - 175/65 R14 tubeless radial
GROUND CLEARANCE	170 mm unladen
SAFETY / COMPLIANCE	**Airbags - ABS - Level 2 ADAS** **AIS-156 - AIS-038 Rev.2 - ECE R100**
BMS	Cell-level voltage + temperature monitoring
INTERIOR / COMFORT	5-seat - 2row - rear-biased - flat floor (no tunnel) Rear AC vents - durable leatherette - ventilated front seats EPS - Full LED - DRL bar - Fog lamps
TOP VARIANT	Panoramic sunroof
LUGGAGE	upto 400 L
BATTERY FIRST-LIFE	15 yr (cycle-life basis & to be validated by supplier)
CORROSION / NVH	to be validated for coastal and monsoon deployment
PRIMARY WEAR ITEM	Bearings
SEGMENT	Compact Sedan - B-segment

3,995	1,684	1,532	2,450
LENGTH MM	WIDTH MM	HEIGHT MM	WHEELBASE MM

POWERTRAIN STRATEGY

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01 — COMPARISON AND JUSTIFICATION

	BEV	HEV	PHEV	CNG	BIO CNG
COST/KM (OPERATOR)	₹6.42	₹9–11	₹8–10	₹7.42–8.34	≈ CNG + supply risk
REFUELLING READINESS	Depot AC overnight; zero revenue-hour downtime	Full — ICE base	Full — ICE base	Best-in-class	Best-in-class
RANGE / UPTIME	315 km real (verified)	Unaffected	Unaffected	~500–600 km real	~500–600 km real
SUSTAINABILITY	Best available on a coal-heavy grid	Marginal	Marginal	Methane slip; worse CO2	Genuinely low-carbon but supply immature
CHOSEN BY REGULATORS	Yes — Delhi gazette 100% by 2030	No	No	No	No

India has roughly 35,000 public charging ports for 5.7 million registered EVs — 160 EVs per port (NITI Aayog index, via Cadmus/Uber). Public charging is therefore not an operating plan for a fleet. It is a fallback.

WHY NOT THE ALTERNATIVES?

BEV offers the lowest operating cost for our 200 km/day depot-based duty cycle, with cheaper energy, lower maintenance, and overnight charging that avoids revenue loss. LFP keeps the battery cost-effective and durable.

CNG — THE REAL COMPETITOR, AND IT LOSES ON COST

CNG wins refuelling readiness and has a far lower purchase price. It loses because at 200 km/day the running-cost saving is not enough to cover the ₹5.49 lakh capital premium within five years, after which EV wins for the remaining life.

BIO-CNG — THE OPTION THAT IS NOT READY

Bio-CNG has the best carbon story of any fuel available, and it is not deliverable at fleet scale in 2035:

- *207 CBG plants commissioned as of April 2026, against a government target of 5,000 by 2030*
- *Only 17 of those 207 are pipeline-connected — the rest move by high-pressure cascade*
- *Commissioned capacity is ~2 MMTPA against a 15 MMTPA target*
- *Operating plants run at 20–60% of rated capacity on feedstock inconsistency*
- *Mandatory blending is only 1% in FY2025-26, rising to 5% by FY2028-29*

HEV AND PHEV — STRUCTURALLY UNCOMPETITIVE HERE

CEEW is unambiguous:
"Petrol-electric hybrid vehicles... are significantly more expensive, mainly due to the high GST and compensation cess [at 43 per cent], making them uncompetitive in this segment against EVs."
The tax treatment alone is disqualifying. Beyond that, both inherit the ICE's full mechanical service burden — the exact cost line where EV gains its advantage — while adding a battery and inverter to a fleet that will keep both.

BEV. LFP. SINGLE-SPEED DRIVE.

High-mileage taxis favour EVs on total cost of ownership, with CNG as the alternative where infrastructure exists. — CEEW

200 km/day makes the economics work.

Fleet parity with diesel typically emerges at 120–200 km/day, with 18–24-month payback. Our depot-return duty cycle sits at the favourable end of this range.

Depot charging eliminates downtime.

A 36 kWh recharge (10–90%) takes 4.9 hours at 7.4 kW or 3.3 hours at 11 kW—completed overnight, with zero revenue hours lost.

Cheap, scheduled charging protects margins.

Depot electricity at ₹5.50–9/kWh beats public fast charging at ₹18–24/kWh. Smart off-peak scheduling can cut charging costs by 20–35%, with a feasible 1:3 charger-to-vehicle ratio.

02 — CHARGING & REFUELING READINESS

WHY BEV WOULD WORK?

	TIME FOR 36 KWH (10→90%)	FITS OVERNIGHT WINDOW?
7.4 KW AC	4.9 h	Yes
11 KW AC	3.3 h	Yes
22 KW AC	1.6 h	Yes

CHARGING ROUTE	COST
PUBLIC DC FAST CHARGE	₹18–24 /kWh
DEPOT, OFF-PEAK COMMERCIAL TARIFF	₹5.50–9 /kWh
DEPOT + ROOFTOP SOLAR	₹3–5 /kWh

PACK SIZING HEADROOM

MACH1(EV)

200 KM/DAY	34 kWh → 45 kWh
263 KM/DAY	45 kWh
300 KM/DAY	51 kWh → 45 kWh

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENS WITHOUT DEPOT CHARGING

"Around two-and-a-half months after... Green SM launched its electric taxi service... drivers said they are spending hours waiting for chargers or going offline to conserve battery... I sometimes come to charge my vehicle on my week-offs." — The Indian Express, 1 Sep 2026, Noida

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A SECOND CHEMISTRY.
A SOVEREIGN SUPPLY CHAIN.
A CALCULATED BET ON 2035.

THE SOVEREIGN'S BET

THE INDUSTRY HAS A DEFAULT. WE HAVE A DIFFERENT THESIS.
SODIUM-ION NEED NOT DEFEAT LITHIUM-ION TODAY. IT NEEDS TO BECOME A CREDIBLE ALTERNATIVE BY 2035. MACH1 IS DESIGNED TO GIVE IT THAT CHANCE—WITH LFP AS THE FALLBACK AND THE FINAL CHEMISTRY DECIDED BY COST, SUPPLY SECURITY AND DEMONSTRATED PERFORMANCE.

1. BATTERY INDEPENDENCE IS STRATEGIC, NOT JUST ECONOMIC.

India's EV supply chain remains heavily dependent on imported lithium-ion cells and materials. **Sodium-ion offers a second chemistry**—reducing lithium dependence, enabling aluminium current collectors, and creating opportunities for domestic supply-chain control. The goal is not to replace LFP, but to reduce reliance on a single chemistry.

2. 2035 GIVES THE TECHNOLOGY TIME TO MATURE.

Sodium-ion manufacturing remains small today, but major manufacturers are scaling development, with improved low-temperature performance and growing industrial interest. **MACH1 does not bet on sodium-ion winning; it preserves the option.**

3. A STAGED DECISION KEEPS THE RISK CONTAINED.

- **By 2032–33**: Adopt sodium-ion only if it meets cost, performance, and supply-chain requirements.
- **If it falls short:** Launch with LFP, the established fallback.
- **Design principle:** One vehicle architecture, two battery pathways, no dependence on an unproven outcome.

PUBLIC FUNDING IS MOVING SODIUM-ION RESEARCH TOWARDS COMMERCIALISATION

May 2025 — JNCASR develops a fast-charging sodium-ion cell

The Department of Science and Technology (DST) publicised research by the Jawaharlal Nehru Centre for Advanced Scientific Research (JNCASR), reporting a sodium-ion battery that charged to 80% in six minutes and achieved more than 3,000 charge cycles in the reported testing.

December 2025 — ARCI moves into industrial cell validation

The International Advanced Research Centre for Powder Metallurgy and New Materials (ARCI), an autonomous R&D institution under DST, signed an agreement with Voltasun Technologies on 15 December 2025 to supply 80 sodium-ion pouch cells rated at 5 Ah each for industrial-performance evaluation.

December 2025 — Government-backed Indo-Israel industrial R&D

The Technology Development Board (TDB), under DST, entered into an agreement with NOPO Nanotechnologies India under the India–Israel Industrial R&D and Technological Innovation Fund. The project investigates integrating single-walled carbon nanotubes into sodium-ion batteries and developing a proof-of-concept prototype.

April 2026 — Direct support for commercial-scale sodium-ion materials

TDB announced financial assistance to Indigenous Energy Storage Technologies Pvt. Ltd. for commercialisation of hard carbon derived from agricultural and other biomass waste, intended for use as a sodium-ion battery anode material.
This is strategically important because hard carbon is a key sodium-ion input, and the IEA identifies its supply chain as underdeveloped and heavily concentrated in China

9th September 2026 — NTPC issues a sodium-ion grid-storage pilot EOI

This is one of the clearest current policy signals. NTPC's official tender portal records an Expression of Interest titled "EOI for Setting up A Pilot Project for Development and Installation of a Grid-Connected BESS using Sodium-Ion Battery Technology."

BROADER NATIONAL POLICY IS CREATING THE CONDITIONS FOR BATTERY-CHEMISTRY DIVERSIFICATION

Together, these initiatives demonstrate a national effort to reduce dependence on imported battery inputs and build domestic manufacturing capability. Sodium-ion is relevant to that objective because it offers an alternative pathway with a different raw-material profile.

NATIONAL PROGRAMME ON ADVANCED CHEMISTRY CELL BATTERY STORAGE.

The Ministry of Heavy Industries' PLI scheme has an approved outlay of ₹18,100 crore to build gigascale advanced-chemistry-cell manufacturing in India, with a stated emphasis on domestic value addition. The scheme provides an industrial framework for building battery manufacturing capabilities

NATIONAL CRITICAL MINERAL MISSION

Approved in January 2025, the mission provides for ₹16,300 crore in public expenditure over seven years, with an expected ₹18,000 crore of investment from public-sector undertakings and other stakeholders. Its purpose is to strengthen domestic critical-mineral value chains across exploration, mining, processing and recovery.

ICEA ENERGY STORAGE REQUIREMENTS

India's Central Electricity Authority has estimated an energy-storage requirement of approximately 411 GWh by 2031–32, driven by the need to integrate renewable electricity reliably. The figure was reported in a December 2025 parliamentary response published by the Ministry of Power.

INDIA IS PURSUING BATTERY SELF-RELIANCE AND CRITICAL-MINERAL DIVERSIFICATION; SODIUM-ION IS EMERGING AS ONE TECHNOLOGY CAPABLE OF CONTRIBUTING TO THOSE GOALS.

WHY 2035 DOES NOT SOLVE IT

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This is not a naive claim, and it deserves a fair hearing. Sodium-ion's cost trajectory is real, and layered-oxide sodium cells genuinely do reach LFP price parity on a five-year view.
IT FAILS ON TIMING AND CERTIFICATION, NOT ON DIRECTION.

WALL 1 - AVAILABILITY AT SCALE

Current automotive deployments are 23–25 kWh microcars, not sedan-class vehicles. CATL's Naxtra has GWh-scale capacity and passenger-car certification, but uses Prussian White—not the layered-oxide chemistry specified for MACH1. These chemistries are not interchangeable drop-in solutions.
Decision: Layered-oxide sodium-ion remains a future option, not a launch-ready cell. LFP remains the fallback unless the specified chemistry reaches the required scale, performance, and certification by 2032–33.

WALL 2 — IT CANNOT BE LEGALLY HOMOLOGATED IN INDIA.

AIS-038 REV.2 AMENDMENT 3, ANNEX IX-K(2), VERBATIM:
"CELLS USED TO MAKE REESS, SHALL BE CERTIFIED AS PER IS 16893-PART 2 AND PART 3 BY NABL ACCREDITED LAB OR BY TEST AGENCY NOTIFIED UNDER CMV RULE 126."
IS 16893-2 AND -3 ARE TITLED "SECONDARY LITHIUM-ION CELLS...". NO AMENDMENT THROUGH AMD 4 HAS ADDED AN ALTERNATIVE-CHEMISTRY CLAUSE OR SCOPE EXEMPTION. NO SODIUM-ION CELL HAS EVER BEEN CERTIFIED TO THEM.

DECISION

LFP IS THE LAUNCH CHEMISTRY. SODIUM-ION IS THE 2036–38 SECOND PHASE, *RETAINED THROUGH A DUAL-CHEMISTRY ARCHITECTURE. THE ISSUE IS NOT SODIUM-ION'S POTENTIAL, BUT ITS READINESS: IT CANNOT MEET THE PROPOSED CERTIFICATION TIMELINE.* ***IF IT CANNOT BE CERTIFIED, IT CANNOT BE DELIVERED.***

ARCHITECTURE

WHY DETACHABLE, NOT STRUCTURAL

- *CHEMISTRY SWAP BECOMES A* ***SOFTWARE CHANGE,*** *NOT A NEW CAR*
- ***AIS-038 CLAUSE 2.48:*** *A CHEMISTRY CHANGE NEEDS FULL REESS RETEST EITHER WAY*
- *BUT* ***DETACHABLE MAKES THE CELL SWAPPABLE.*** *STRUCTURAL CTC LOCKS THE CHEMISTRY FOREVER*
- *COST OF THAT OPTIONALITY: ₹2–3 CR / 4–6 MONTHS VS ₹15–25 CR / 18–24 MONTHS*

DIMENSION	DETACHED SEMI-STRUCTURAL CTP	FULL STRUCTURAL CTC
Chemistry change	Cell swap + firmware	Effectively impossible
AIS-038 Clause 2.48 retest	4–6 months, 2–3 Cr	18–24 months, 15–25 Cr
Cell standardisation	256×106×32 prismatic, 102–108s	Chemistry-locked
Repurposing / second life	Straightforward	Very difficult
Body programme impact	None	Full body-in-white retool

Pack sizing	SoH at year 8	Design cell temp
44.2 kWh @ 48°C cell	77.3% — commercially viable past loan payoff	48°C max under liquid cooling

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TOTAL COST OF OWNERSHIP ANALYSIS

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0. METHODOLOGY
STEP-BY-STEP COST ANALYSIS

1. **Define the operating case:** Compare both vehicles at 200 km/day over five- and eight-year ownership periods.
2. **Collect input data:** Gather vehicle prices, financing terms, energy efficiency, tariffs, maintenance, insurance, taxes and resale values across three cities.
3. **Calculate acquisition cost:** Use the on-road price for cash purchases or total EMI payments for financed purchases, never both.
4. **Calculate energy cost:** Estimate lifetime electricity and CNG expenditure, accounting for charging losses and applicable tariffs.
5. **Calculate maintenance and insurance:** Include servicing, repairs, tyres, insurance and other relevant operating expenses.
6. **Assess uptime and lost earnings:** Evaluate charging and repair downtime and its potential impact on operating revenue.
7. **Account for residual value:** Estimate and deduct the vehicle's resale value at the end of ownership.
8. **Calculate TCO and cost/km:** Combine ownership and operating costs, subtract residual value, and calculate total cost and cost per kilometre.
9. **Compare operator and driver economics:** Evaluate ownership costs, operating expenses and driver take-home earnings separately.
10. **Validate and test sensitivity:** Verify calculations against external sources and test variations in energy prices, efficiency, daily distance, financing, downtime, resale value and battery replacement.

2.ECONOMIC BOUNDARY

INCLUDED	DETAIL
ACQUISITION	Ex-showroom, GST, road tax (per vehicle)
FINANCING	Full EMI stream, 10% / 60 months
ENERGY	Tariff × consumption, net of charging losses
MAINTENANCE	Fleet service cost, net of the EV tyre-wear premium
INSURANCE	OD premium, actual, EV higher than CNG
CHARGING INFRA-STRUCTURE	Charger capex, installation, DISCOM load sanction, N+1 redundancy, management software, AMC, and replacement at year 5
DOWNTIME	Foregone net earnings, decomposed by cause
RESIDUAL	Credit at end of horizon, escalated
CNG-SIDE INFRA	Periodic cylinder hydro-testing

1. CONFIGURATION USED

VEHICLE	MACH1 — BEV, LFP 45 kWh, PMSM 80 bhp continuous, single-speed
COMPARATOR	Maruti Dzire Tour S (CNG)
DUTY	200 km/day × 26 days × 312 days = 5,200 km/mo · 62,400 km/yr
CONSUMPTION	12.84 kWh/100 km (verified duty cycle, battery phase
CHARGING	Depot AC overnight, 90% wall-to-battery efficiency
GROSS FARE	₹11/km net fare → ₹57,200/month
PLATFORM FEE	₹67/vehicle-day (Ola zero-commission) → ₹1,742/month
NET FARE	₹10.665/km → ₹55,458/month (derived)
FINANCING	10% annual, 60 months, no down payment (deck's assumption)
HORIZON	5 years (loan) and 8 years (battery-phase horizon)
DISCOUNT RATE	12% nominal annual — a fleet operator's hurdle rate
ESCALATION	Electricity 4.5% · CNG 3.5% · maintenance 4.0% · insurance 5.0% · residual 4.5%
CITIES	Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru — different tariffs, road tax and CNG prices

3. THE COST STACK
DELHI, 5 YEARS, FINANCED (3,4,5)

COMPONENT	EV	CNG	EV ADVANTAGE
On-road (ex-showroom + GST + road tax)	₹12,72,600	₹8,51,488	−₹4,21,112
Finance (EMI ₹29,743 / ₹18,092 × 60)	₹16,22,339	₹10,85,496	−₹6,99,077
Energy	₹2,00,304	₹9,48,480	+₹7,48,176
Maintenance	₹93,600	₹2,10,000	+₹1,16,400
Insurance	₹2,10,000	₹1,97,400	−₹12,600
Residual Credit	−₹3,30,876	−₹3,40,595	+₹9,719
Subtotal	₹17,95,367	₹21,00,781	+₹3,05,414
Charging infrastructure	₹1,74,000	₹4,500	−₹1,69,500
Total	₹19,69,367	₹21,05,281	+₹1,35,914
Cost/Km	₹6.31	₹6.75	+6.5%

4. OPERATOR TCO — THREE CITIES

CITY	BASIS	EV ₹/km	CNG ₹/km	EV ADV.
Delhi	Financed 60 mo	5.75	6.73	+14.5%
Delhi	Cash outright	4.63	5.98	+22.6%
Mumbai	Financed 60 mo	6.47	7.00	+7.6%
Mumbai	Cash outright	5.35	6.32	+15.3%
Bengaluru	Financed 60 mo	6.66	7.25	+8.2%
Bengaluru	Cash outright	5.45	6.51	+16.4%

*LEVER 1 — **FINANCING STRUCTURE NEARLY DOUBLES THE ADVANTAGE**. CASH PURCHASE GIVES +17.5% AGAINST FINANCED +8.4%, IN THE SAME CITY, ON THE SAME VEHICLE. THE DRAG IS THE INTEREST ON A ₹14 L ASSET: ROUGHLY **₹3.85 L OF INTEREST**, AGAINST ₹2.33 L ON THE CNG.*

*THAT IS A NEGOTIATION LEVER, NOT A PHYSICS ONE. A FLEET OPERATOR BUYING AT SCALE CAN NEGOTIATE A LONGER TENURE, A LOWER RATE, OR AN EV-SPECIFIC PRODUCT. **A 7-YEAR TENURE MOVES MOST OF THE HORIZON FROM "FINANCED" TO "CASH," AND THAT IS WORTH MORE THAN ANY TARIFF NEGOTIATION WE COULD WIN.***

HORIZON	EV ₹/km	CNG ₹/km	EV ADV.no infra	With infra	NPV + infra
5yr	5.75	6.73	+14.5%	+6.5%	+6.7%
6yr	5.06	6.34	+20.1%	-	-
7yr	4.57	6.05	+24.4%	-	-
8yr	4.20	5.84	+28.0%	+17.4%	+14.6%

*LEVER 2 — **HOLD THE VEHICLE LONGER.***
*DELHI, FINANCED. THE CASE ROUGHLY **TRIPLES BY YEAR 8** BECAUSE THE LOAN IS REPAID AND THE ASSET KEEPS EARNING. THIS IS THE STRONGEST SINGLE ARGUMENT IN THE DOCUMENT AND IT IS AN OPERATOR ARGUMENT — IT BELONGS TO WHOEVER OWNS THE VEHICLE.*

5.SENSITIVITY-

INPUT CHANGE	EV ADVANTAGE
BASE (DELHI: ELEC ₹4.50, CNG ₹76/KG, 25 KM/KG)	**+14.5%**
CNG 22 KM/KG CITY ONLY, AC ON	**+19.5%**
CNG 30 KM/KG — HIGHWAY, NOT METRO DUTY	**+7.6%**
CNG PRICE ₹76 → ₹90/KG	**+21.1%**
CNG RESIDUAL 40% → 45%	**+12.8%**
ELECTRICITY ₹4.50 → ₹8.00 (GENERIC COMMERCIAL)	**+7.1%**
ELECTRICITY ₹4.50 → ₹10.00	**+2.9%**
ELECTRICITY ₹4.50 → ₹12.00 (PUBLIC DC)	**−1.4% ✗**
ELECTRICITY ₹4.50 → ₹18.00	**−14.1% ✗**
EV RESIDUAL 26% → 36% (DECK'S OLD ASSUMPTION)	+20.6%
CONSUMPTION 12.84 → 15.38 KWH/100 KM (DECK'S FIGURE)	+12.7%
WORST CASE STACKED (15.38 + ₹12 + RESID 26%)	**−6.4%**
BEST CASE STACKED (12.84 + ₹4.50 + RESID 36%)	**+20.6%**
8-YEAR HORIZON	+28.0%

THREE CONCLUSIONS STAND OUT:

1. ***THE EV ADVANTAGE HOLDS UP AGAINST MEASURED CNG EFFICIENCY.*** *THE MEASURED BAND LEAVES AN EV ADVANTAGE OF **+19.5%** TO **+11.6%**, GIVING THE CASE A REASONABLE MARGIN UNDER THESE ASSUMPTIONS.*
2. ***ENERGY PRICES REMAIN THE REAL FRAGILITY.*** *ABOVE ROUGHLY ₹11/KWH, THE **EV LOSES ITS ADVANTAGE.** DEPOT TARIFFS OF ₹4.50–9.50/KWH SUPPORT THE CASE, WHILE PUBLIC DC CHARGING AT ₹12–24/KWH CAN OVERTURN IT.*
3. *UPTIME IS THE BINDING OPERATIONAL RISK. THE **EV HAS 45 HOURS/MONTH OF DOWNTIME** HEADROOM, AGAINST A DOCUMENTED **75 HOURS/MONTH LOST TO CHARGER QUEUES** (GREENSM). THE CASE THEREFORE DEPENDS ON RELIABLE DEPOT CHARGING, NOT JUST VEHICLE ECONOMICS*

FACTOR	KEY ASSUMPTIONS AND CALCULATIONS	KEY RESULTS / BREAK-EVEN THRESHOLDS	IMPLICATION
1. Depot charging	Daily energy: 25.68 kWh; 7.4 kW AC charging takes ~3.86 h. Charger cost: ₹50,000 hardware + ₹30,000 installation + ₹10,000 DISCOM connection, increased to ₹99,000/vehicle for N+1 redundancy. Software and AMC: ₹15,000/year.	Depot off-peak tariffs: ₹5.50–9/kWh; public DC retail: ₹18–24/kWh. At ₹4.50/kWh, EV energy costs ₹0.64/km; at ₹8.50, ₹1.21/km; at ₹12, ₹1.71/km.	Depot charging is essential. The report's ₹12/kWh sensitivity turns negative, and public DC retail tariffs are typically higher. Charger infrastructure must be included in TCO.
2. Vehicle uptime	Baseline downtime: 3.5 h/month—0.5 h queues/port unavailability, 1 h planned maintenance, 1.5 h repairs and 0.5 h charger failure. Net cost of lost operating time: ₹200.46/hour.	Baseline loss: ₹702/month, ₹0.135/km or ₹42,097 over five years. Break-even: 25.4 total downtime hours/month, leaving 21.9 additional hours beyond baseline. A reported ~75 h/month without depot charging produces a −28.4% result.	Reliable depot access is a contractual operating requirement, not an automatic property of the vehicle. Charging queues and repairs can erase savings.
3. Battery replacement risk	Main eight-year case assumes no pack replacement. The report's replacement sensitivity uses an earlier nominal, vehicle-only comparison basis.	No replacement: ₹5.75/km, +14.5% EV advantage. ₹4 lakh replacement: ₹7.04/km, −4.5%; ₹8 lakh: ₹8.32/km, −23.5%; ₹12 lakh: ₹9.60/km, −42.6%.	Even a ₹4 lakh replacement reverses the earlier comparison. Battery warranty, capacity-retention guarantees and replacement terms are critical. Recalculate scenarios on the final NPV-inclusive basis before comparing them with the headline result.
4. Battery life and EFC	Battery-side throughput: 8,012 kWh/year. EFC estimates: 178/year using nominal 45 kWh capacity; 181.3 using usable 44.2 kWh; 197.8 using wall energy divided by nominal capacity.	Consistent calculation gives 178 EFC/year and 16.85 years to 3,000 cycles, versus 197.8 EFC/year and 15.16 years on the published basis. Calendar-ageing estimates range from 3.7 years to 80% capacity under a measured linear model to 13.3 years under a √t model at 40°C.	The published EFC figure overstates cycle throughput by 11.1% because it mixes wall energy with battery capacity. Cycle life does not guarantee service life; calendar ageing may dominate.

MARUTI SUZUKI

DRIVER P&L — FLEET-OPERATED VEHICLE

Monthly line	EV	CNG
Gross revenue (₹11 × 5,200 km)	₹57,200	₹57,200
less platform access fee (₹67/day × 26)	−₹1,742	−₹1,742
less energy	−₹3,338	−₹15,808
less maintenance	−₹1,560	−₹3,500
less insurance	−₹3,500	−₹3,290
Take-home	₹47,060	₹32,860
Advantage	+₹14,200 / month	
Annualised	₹5,64,715	₹3,94,320
Five-year cumulative		+₹8,51,976

EV ADVANTAGE IS A FIXED NUMBER

1. *The EV advantage is ₹14,200 every month, at every fare and every duty level. It does not scale with earnings — it scales with* ***nothing.***
2. *So the same ₹14,200 is worth twice as much in percentage to the lowest-paid driver.A driver on a ₹11/km street fare gains 43%. A driver on a ₹22/km airport run gains 16%. Both get the identical rupees.*
3. *And it barely moves with duty — at 150 km/day the EV take-home is 145% of the CNG's, at 300 km/day it is 141%. The* ***ratio is stable.***

Fare	EV take-home	CNG take-home	Advantage	As % uplift
₹11/km	₹47,060	₹32,860	₹14,200	+43.2%
₹14/km	₹62,660	₹48,460	₹14,200	+29.3%
₹18/km	₹83,460	₹69,260	₹14,200	+20.5%
₹22/km	₹1,04,260	₹90,060	₹14,200	+15.8%

WHAT THE PLATFORM TAKES IS IRRELEVANT

Platform model	EV take-home	CNG takehome	Advantage
Flat ₹67/day (Ola/Uber/Rapido)	₹47,060	₹32,860	₹14,200
Legacy 20% per ride	₹48,799	₹34,600	₹14,200
Legacy 25% per ride	₹48,799	₹34,599	₹14,200

DRIVER EARNINGS

GROSS EARNINGS @ VARYING FARE RATES

	Arithmetic	Result
₹93,600	₹18.00/km × 5,200 km/month	₹93,600
₹114,400	₹22.00/km × 5,200 km/month	₹114,400

DRIVER P&L — DRIVER-OWNED VEHICLE

	EV	CNG
Take-home during the 60-month loan	₹20,021	₹14,768
Take-home year 6 onward	₹47,060	₹32,860
Advantage during loan	+₹5,252 / month	
Advantage after loan	+₹14,200 / month	

HOW ROBUST IS THE DRIVER CASE?

The driver advantage is far more robust than the operator advantage. The operator case is sensitive to charger cost and duty; the driver case survives almost everything, because it is a difference between two cost stacks, not a margin that can be squeezed.

Stress test	Result
CNG price rises to ₹200/kg (today ₹76)	Advantages increases drasti
Duty falls from 200 to 150 km/day	+₹10,597 instead of ₹14,200 — still positive
Fare halves to ₹5.50/km (legacy commission)	Advantage still ₹14,200
Platform switches to per-ride commission	No change to the advantage

WHAT WE WILL NOT CLAIM ON THE DRIVER SIDE

- *Not ₹93,600 in take-home earnings. That is gross revenue; take-home is ₹47,060 at the assumed fare. At ₹11/km, it falls to ₹20,021 if the driver also finances the vehicle.*
- *Not universal driver profitability. Below roughly 60 km/day, one vehicle cannot cover the driver's fixed costs. This is a utilisation problem, not a powertrain problem.*
- *Not better income simply because the vehicle drives better. The economic gain comes from a ₹1.24 lakh/month reduction in operating costs.*

RIDER REVIEWS

XCELerate 2026

WHAT RIDERS ACTUALLY COMPLAIN ABOUT

COMPLAINT	SHARE
Driver cancelled after learning destination or payment	74%
Surge pricing	62%
Long waiting times	53%
Unclean vehicles	30%
Driver behaviour	25%
Safety concerns	6%

LocalCircles surveyed **17,993 respondents across 325 districts (2025):**
A separate Bengaluru survey (10,000+ responses) found ***85%*** *of Uber users and* ***93%*** *of Ola users reported at least one of: cancellations, phone use while driving, surge pricing, unclean cars.*

WHAT RIDERS SAY ABOUT THE VEHICLE

Owner reviews repeat four praises — mileage, low maintenance, service-network reach, ride comfort and four complaints: a basic cabin, no infotainment, no rear AC vents, and a 3-cylinder that feels underpowered. One owner put it plainly: "Only perfect for taxi like Ola or Uber, because safety you have to compromise. For personal I would not prefer."

There is also a brand problem worth naming: owners of the new-generation Dzire note it is"comfortable and looks premium, but still seen as cabs." The taxi image is the stigma.

MARUTI DZIRE TOUR S

Sub-rating	Score
Mileage	5.0 / 5
Maintenance cost	4.9 / 5
Performance	4.8 / 5
Comfort	4.7 / 5
Safety	4.1 / 5
Features & styling	1.2 / 5

WHAT THE RIDER EVIDENCE SAYS WE SHOULD CHANGE

1. *Fix the features gap. The benchmark vehicle scores* ***1.2/5 on features****. An EV programme is exactly when to add what the CNG generation never got — rear AC vents, a real infotainment system, connected features. Riders rate tangibility third, but they rate it, and the incumbent's weakest score is ours to take.*
2. ***Front and rear dashcams*** *as standard. Riders name them as a differentiator on premium EV services. Cheap to specify, directly addresses safety which is the top stated priority.*
3. *The* ***boot is a customer feature****. Airport transfers are the margin segment, and the Dzire Tour S manages 382 L. At 400 L we already lead; we should say so in customer terms, not dimension terms.*

THE UNCOMFORTABLE CUSTOMER FINDING

The rider's top complaint is ***cancellation****, and our vehicle* ***cannot fix*** *it on its own.. A driver cancels because the trip is unprofitable or the destination is awkward. Depot charging and a ₹99,000 charger that stays working make the driver more reliable , that is a real causal chain , but the honest position is that vehicle design moves rider satisfaction at the margin, and the large* ***win is in fleet operations.***

WHERE MACHI WINS AND LOSES

Rider priority	Evidence	Our position
Reliability	Top SERVQUAL predictor; 74% top complaint is cancellation	Strongest claim. A 21.9 h/month downtime slack and a depot-charging operating model are the mechanism — a vehicle that is not queueing for a charger is a vehicle that shows up
Tangibility / condition	β=.182 predictor; 30% complain of unclean cars	Neutral-to-good. Silence and consistent cabin spec are a genuine upgrade; features are where the Dzire scores 1.2/5, and an EV is the moment to fix that
Empathy / courtesy	β=.263 predictor	Operator-controlled, not vehicle-controlled. Driver economics feeding §4 is the indirect lever
Price fairness	Explains 47.6% of satisfaction variation	EV caps operator cost but does not guarantee a fairer fare to the rider — this needs a platform commitment, and we should not claim it as a vehicle feature
Safety	Top stated priority; 6% formal complaints	Already specified: L2 ADAS, airbags, ABS. Note the fleet reality — rear seatbelt compliance is a behaviour problem, not a hardware one
Quiet / comfort	Most-praised EV attribute	Free win. An EV sedan is quieter than the CNG sedan it replaces, in the segment where noise is already the top complaint

AI & CONNECTED MOBILITY



TIRE PRESSURE MONITORING SYSTEM

- Continuous Monitoring — Pressure and temperature measured per wheel in real time, displayed live on dashboard with per-wheel status.
- Three-Level Threshold — Normal: 32–35 psi, 30–50°C. Warning: below 28 psi or above 60°C. Critical: below 22 psi or above 70°C — VCU alert triggered at each level.
- Leak Detection — Rate of pressure drop monitored continuously. Rapid or gradual loss flagged before reaching critical threshold, logged to VCU and cloud.
- System Value — Correct pressure reduces rolling resistance and extends range. Early detection prevents mid-shift tyre failures on revenue-earning vehicles.

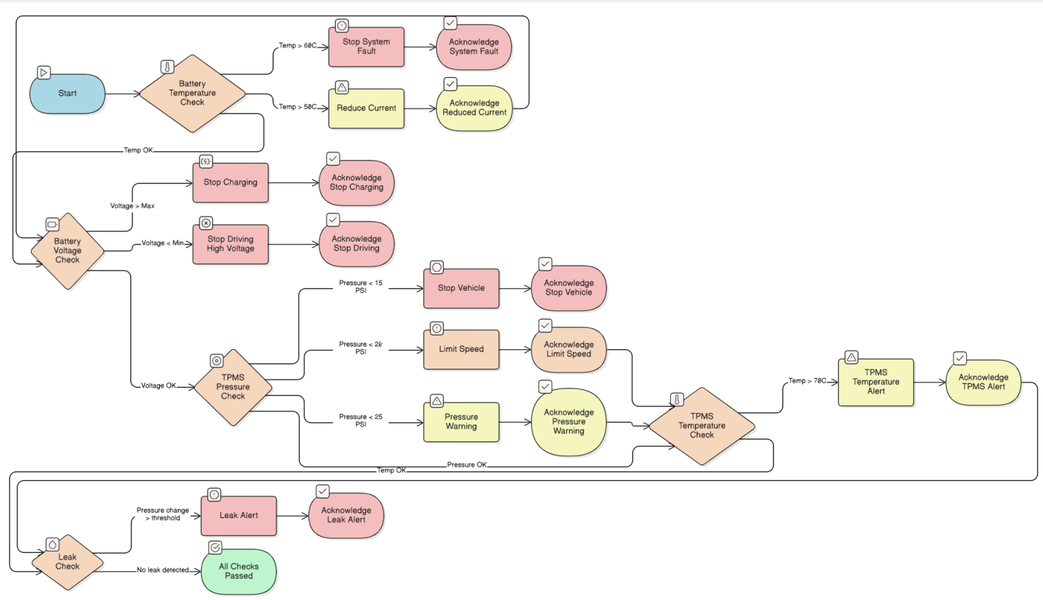


FAST CHARGING SYSTEM

- Initialization & Safety Check — System verifies battery connection, reads voltage, current and temperature. Charging stops automatically if any parameter is outside safe limits.
- CC Phase — Fixed high current delivered until battery reaches peak voltage. Charges to ~70–80% capacity quickly.
- CV Phase — Voltage held constant, current tapers down to threshold. Prevents overcharging and thermal stress on cells.
- Continuous Monitoring — Parameters tracked throughout. All safety checks remain active. Data logged to VCU and cloud in real time.

INTEGRATED BATTERY & TYRE SAFETY MANAGEMENT

- Battery Safety: Temperature and voltage thresholds trigger current reduction, charging shutdown, or vehicle cutoff.
- Tyre & Leak Monitoring: TPMS checks pressure, temperature, and sudden pressure drops; unsafe conditions trigger alerts, speed limits, or vehicle stop.
- Fault & Reset Logic: All faults require acknowledgement before reset; checks continuously repeat until all conditions pass.

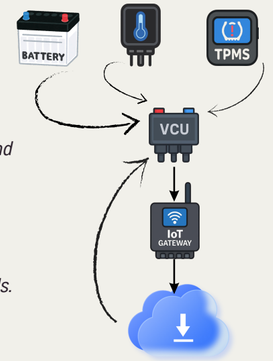


SENSE. THINK. ACT.

System Workflow

1. *Sensor Acquisition & Safety Checks*
   - *Read voltage, current, temperature and pressure on each trigger.*
   - *Check overvoltage, overcurrent and temperature limits. If any check fails, bypass AI and immediately initiate the appropriate safety action.*
2. *Fault Detection, Calculations & Data Transmission*
   - *In parallel, detect cell imbalance, implausible sensor readings and abnormal tyre-pressure drops; calculate SOC using current integration and*
   - *SOH using charge-discharge history.*
   - *Transmit data via BLE to the driver's app and Wi-Fi to the cloud for fleet monitoring.*
3. *AI-Based Analysis*
   - *Fault Prediction: Use historical patterns and current readings to identify developing faults, such as cell degradation, temperature drift and bearing wear.*
   - *Charging Optimisation: Adapt charging parameters using SOC and SOH, including lowering the constant-current (CC) limit for degraded cells.*
4. *Action & Repeat*
   - *Respond with a warning, real-time parameter adjustment (charging current or motor torque), or hard cutoff for critical faults.*
   - *Return to the wait state and repeat the cycle on the next trigger.*

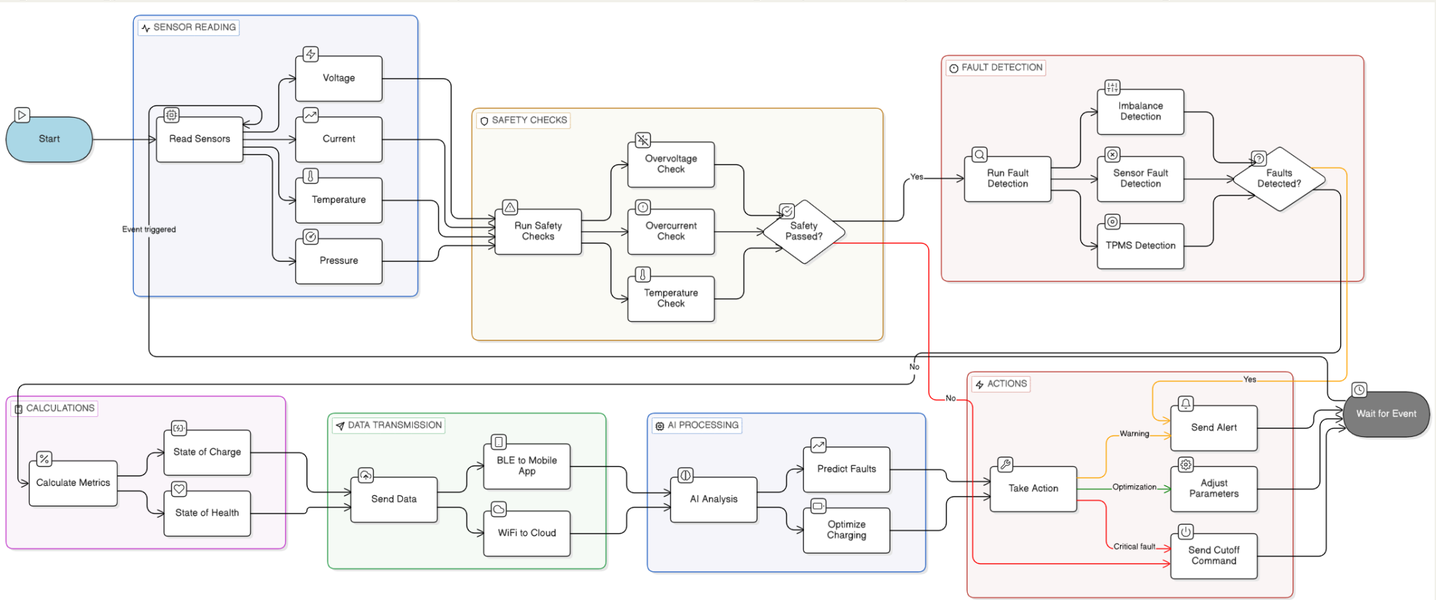
SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE



ILLUSTRATIVE PILOT TARGETS — SUBJECT TO VALIDATION

- Fleet Monitoring — live dashboard per vehicle: SOC, location, faults, battery status
- Predictive Maintenance — early fault detection by detecting abnormal fault patterns, **≥7-day advance warning, 20–30% less downtime**
- Smart Dispatch — assign vehicle acc. to available SOC and location matched to demand, **~15% fewer deadhead kilometres**
- Smart Charging — schedule built around shift demand and tariff window, **15–18% lower charging cost**
- Remote Diagnostics — faults identified without physical inspection, reduces workshop time

Targets are hypotheses, not validated results. Baseline performance will be measured during the pilot, and improvements will be evaluated against that baseline.



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ROADMAP

XCELerate 2026

MACH1 · FLEETLINE E1

Roadmap — gated, not dated

FIVE GATES · THREE PHASES

Measurements decide each step

1 **Phase 1** — 2026–27 · Delhi NCR

G **Gates G1–G3** — cell · duty · battery

2 **Phase 2** — 2028–30 · Delhi + Bengaluru + Mumbai

G **Gate G4** — scale

3 **Phase 3** — 2031–35 · Pan-India

G **Gate G5** — cells

PHASE 1

2026–27 · Delhi NCR

- **1,000–2,000 vehicles**
- Margin segment: airport transfers + corporate commute
- 1 × 7.4 kW AC port per vehicle, 10% N+1 spares, ₹99,000/vehicle installed
- Overnight window 25.68 kWh ÷ (7.4 kW × 0.90) = 3.86 h — one port is enough, no DC needed
- Cells: Reliance Jamnagar LFP primary, qualified import as bridge, dual-sourced from day one
- Power: ₹4.50/kWh Delhi BEE EV tariff

1,000–2,000 is indicative, gate-conditional — not a forecast.

PHASE 2

2028–30 · Delhi + Bengaluru + Mumbai

- All three cities clear at five years on the published basis (see ECONOMICS)
- **Cumulative 15,000–25,000 vehicles**

PHASE 3

2031–35 · Pan-India

- **100,000+ cumulative**

G1 · CELL

Two qualified LFP sources at price parity within 10%.

FAIL → Stay dual-imported; do not commit Phase 2 volume.

G2 · DUTY

12 months of measured paid km/day ≥ 200.

FAIL → Re-run the TCO before scaling; the whole case is duty-sensitive.

G3 · BATTERY

12 months of per-cell SoH telemetry closing the 3.6× disagreement in published LFP time-to-80% (Naumann √t gives 13.3 yr at 40 °C; Lewerenz's measured linear law gives 3.7 yr).

FAIL → Capacity-retention guarantee is unsignable.

G4 · SCALE

20,000 cumulative vehicles with the 21.9 h/month downtime slack maintained against a 25–40% public-charger session-failure rate.

FAIL → Downtime slack is consumed; hold the fleet at Phase 2 volume.

G5 · CELLS

Measured operating domestic LFP capacity >20 GWh with automotive qualification. A measurement, not a date.

FAIL → Domestic content stays at L2; the import bridge continues.

LOCALISATION

L1 pack assembly 2026–27 → **L2 domestic cells for a share 2028–30** → **L3 CAM/AM/separator content 2031+**

L3 only if gated. The honest ceiling: ACC PLI has delivered 1.4 GWh of 50 GWh — 2.8%. Reliance Jamnagar is the LFP player (40 GWh, ramping H2 2026); Ola Cell is the only Indian producer at scale and is NMC-first.

INFRASTRUCTURE

One AC port per vehicle. AIS-138 Part 2 amended 2022 to mandate CCS2 for four-wheelers; OCPP 1.6J.
Beyond ~300 km one-way, destination charging is mandatory — a fleet-contract requirement, not a vehicle spec.
Range envelope: 268 km at 15% reserve (315 km at zero).
Feasible: Delhi–Agra 200 · Mumbai–Pune 150 · Mumbai–Nashik 170 · Bengaluru–Mysuru 145. Marginal: Delhi–Jaipur 280 (88.8% of usable).

POLICY

STATE	WHAT IT GIVES	EXPIRY
Delhi	0% road tax for life of vehicle; ₹1 lakh scrapping incentive. No purchase incentive for electric cars.	**31-Mar-2030**
Maharashtra	15% of ex-factory, capped ₹2 lakh, for transport e-4W — 25,000 units; 100% toll exemption on Mumbai–Pune Expressway and Samruddhi Mahamarg; EV road-tax exempt.	**31-Mar-2030**
Karnataka	20–25% capex, stamp-duty reimbursement, plug-and-play clusters. No consumer incentive.	**2030**
Central	PM E-DRIVE has no e-4W category at all.	**—**

Both Delhi and Maharashtra expire five years before the 2035 target.

ECONOMICS

NPV at a 12% hurdle, escalated, financed, including the ₹99,000 charger.

	DELHI	MUMBAI	BENGALURU
5-yr	**+6.7%**	**+4.0%**	**+0.9%**
8-yr	**+14.6%**	**+10.6%**	**+9.0%**
2035, 5-yr	**+15.7%**	**+10.4%**	**+9.0%**
2035, 8-yr	**+23.1%**	**+16.4%**	**+16.3%**

Power-escalation break-even at five years: Delhi 14.5%/yr, Mumbai 8.8%, Bengaluru 8.7%. Electricity escalation is unambiguously bad for the EV in every city (worst Mumbai −9.2 pp); the CNG leg is what carries it.

Only one cell in the entire 48-cell model is negative — Bengaluru, 5-yr, cash purchase, −0.4%.

MARUTI SUZUKI

SYNTHESIS

XCELerate 2026

MACH1 · FLEETLINE E1

The argument, in six steps

SYNTHESIS

DELHI · 200 KM/DAY

1

THE PROBLEM

Indian ride-hailing fleets run on CNG — not by preference, because nothing was built for their duty cycle. Fleet duty is 200 km/day, 312 days a year, return-to-base every night. It is the most demanding duty cycle an EV can have, and the one the Indian market has served worst.

2

THE INSIGHT — THE PIVOT

Volume and margin live in different segments, and they need different vehicles.

VOLUME NOT THE LAUNCH SEGMENT

- street-hail intra-city · ~58% of rides
- unpredictable dispatch · price sensitivity 0.85 · ~10% EV adoption

MARGIN THE LAUNCH SEGMENT

- **airport + corporate commute · ~19% combined**
- **144–210 paid km/day · pre-booked | · price sensitivity 0.30–0.35 · ~18% EV adoption**

We did not chase the largest segment. We launched where the economics close and EV adoption already exists.

3

THE VEHICLE

BEV · LFP 45 kWh · PMSM 80 bhp · **268 km at 15% reserve (315 km at zero) · 3,995 mm** — deliberately 5 mm inside the small-car tax line.
Designed around one number: **200 km/day**, return-to-base, one **7.4 kW AC port**, overnight.

4

THE MATH

NPV at a **12%** hurdle, escalated, with the **₹99,000/vehicle depot charger** inside the cost boundary.

	DELHI	MUMBAI	BENGALURU
5-year	+6.7%	+4.0%	+0.9%
8-year	+14.6%	+10.6%	+9.0%

All three clear at five years. One cell in the whole 48-cell model is negative — Bengaluru, bought cash, **−0.4%.**

Broker and platform fees are identical on either powertrain, so the EV-vs-CNG difference is unaffected by how commission is structured.

Inter-city: Delhi–Agra 200, Mumbai–Pune 150, Mumbai–Nashik 170, Bengaluru–Mysuru 145 all fit inside the 268 km envelope. Delhi–Jaipur 280 is marginal. Beyond ~300 km, destination charging is a fleet-contract requirement, not a vehicle spec.

5

WHY LFP, AND WHAT WE ADMIT

Published LFP studies disagree **3.6×** on time-to-80%. So per-cell State-of-Health telemetry is specified, **not optional** — it is the mechanism that makes an 8-year capacity-retention guarantee credible.

6

THE RISK WE CANNOT HEDGE

No central scheme pays for an electric passenger car. PM E-DRIVE's ₹11,900 cr covers 2W, 3W, rickshaws, ambulances, trucks, buses and charging — not 4W cars.
Maharashtra does pay: **15% of ex-factory, capped ₹2 lakh**, for transport e-4W, 25,000 units.

> **And the concessions we do rely on — Delhi's life-of-vehicle road-tax exemption, Maharashtra's e-4W incentive — both expire 31 March 2030, five years before the target year. Renewing them is a policy position worth about five points, not an engineering one.**

1,000–2,000 vehicles, Delhi, gated on cell supply · measured duty · twelve months of our own battery data.